July 2026

KATHRYN H. MCMAHON

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EDUCATION

PhD Geography, University of California, Santa Barbara (Expected 2027)
MA Geography, University of California, Santa Barbara (2023)
BA Geography & Global Studies, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (2021)

FUNDING

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship in Geography (2021-Present: $150,000)
Chancellor's Fellowship, UCSB (2021-Present: $125,000)
Helen Hansma Research Accelerator Grant, UCSB (2025: $10,000)
Broom Center PAA Travel Grant, UCSB (2025: $500)
Schmidt Family Foundation Research Accelerator Grant, UCSB (2024: $8,000)
Dangermond Travel Award, UCSB (2023: $600)
Broom Center PAA Travel Grant, UCSB (2023: $500)
Graduate Climate Conference Travel Grant, UCSB (2022: $140)
NC SECU People Helping People Scholarship, UNC (2017-2021: $10,000)

AWARDS AND HONORS

Geography Excellence in Research Award, UCSB (2026)
All-UC Demography Conference Graduate Student Poster Award (2026)
IPUMS Global Health Research Award (2025)
All-UC Demography Conference Graduate Student Poster Award (2023)
IPUMS Global Health Research Award (2021)
Population Association of America Poster Award (2021)
Alexandre Senior Thesis Research Award, UNC (2020)
Summer Award for a Research-Intensive Course, UNC (2020)

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Humid-heat shifts conceptions and increases pregnancy terminations in Nigeria
Nina Brooks, Cascade Tuholske, **Kathryn McMahon**, Kwaw Andam
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Forthcoming

Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child health in South Asia
Kathryn McMahon, Kathy Baylis, Stuart Sweeney, Chris Funk
Science Advances, 11 (51), eadx3010, 2025

Climate change, social vulnerability and child nutrition in South Asia
Kathryn McMahon, Clark Gray
Global Environmental Change, 71, 102414, 2021

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Will climate-induced humid heat deepen child stunting disparities in South Asia?
Kathryn McMahon, Kathy Baylis, Stuart Sweeney, Chris Funk
Demography, Under Review

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Compound effects of humid heat and air pollution on infant mortality
Kathryn McMahon, Ann James, Simran Koul, Kathy Baylis
In Prep

Does the Social Vulnerability Index Correspond with Exposure to Heat? A Test Case Using California Census Tracts
Elizabeth Ackert, **Kathryn McMahon,** Gabrielle Benoit, Hannah Malak, Frank Davenport, Kathy Baylis, Shraddhanand Shukla
In Prep

PRESENTATIONS (#oral session presenter; %poster presenter; *invited speaker)

2026: UCSB Anthropology Colloquium Series*
2026: World Conference of Environmental and Resource Economists#
2026: All-UC Demography Conference%
2025: American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting%
2025: Population Association of America Annual Meeting#
2024: Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Annual Meeting%
2024: UCSB Geography Department 50th Anniversary Event%
2023: American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting%
2023: All-UC Demography Conference%
2023: Population Association of America Annual Meeting#
2022: Graduate Climate Conference%
2022: Population Association of America Annual Meeting#
2021: Population Association of America Annual Meeting%

MEDIA MENTIONS (selected)

"Humid heat may increase the risk of premature birth. But aspirin could help," The Conversation, May 7, 2026

"Will climate change make us smaller?" BBC News Brasil, May 2, 2026

"Hot, humid conditions during pregnancy undermine child health much more than heat alone," The Current, Dec. 19, 2025

TEACHING, MENTORSHIP, AND SERVICE

2025-2026: Instructor, Math and Statistics Boot Camp, UCSB
2024: Data analysis services for the Central Coast Alliance United for a Sustainable Economy (CAUSE)
2023-2024: Department of Geography Graduate Student Mentor
2021-2023: Mentorship of four UCSB undergraduates (Two students won 1st place in Science & Engineering, 2023 Library Award for Undergraduate Research)
2021-2024: Department of Geography Outreach Committee, UCSB
2020-2021: Volunteer, North Carolina Museum of Life and Science

Referee for: *Population and Environment*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data management & visualization, advanced statistical analysis: R and Stata SE
Spatial analysis and mapping: ArcGIS, QGIS, R
Quasi-experimental designs for causal inference
Calibration and field installation of environmental data loggers
Design, implementation, and analysis of surveys and semi-structured interviews
Integration and analysis of spatial survey data with gridded environmental data
Intermediate spoken and written language: Spanish, French, Hindi-Urdu

REFERENCES

Dr. Kathy Baylis: PhD Committee Chair, Professor, UCSB Geography
Dr. Stuart Sweeney: PhD Committee Member, Professor, UCSB Geography
Dr. Chris Funk: PhD Committee Member, Director, Climate Hazards Center